



National Youth services Council
Diploma in English Course
English Literature
Final Examination
2026 July



Examination No.

Time: 3 hours

Answer all questions. (100 marks)

PART 1

SECTION- A

1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions below.

- a). "The gates of the chapel were shut,
And "Thou shall not" writ over the door,
So I turned to the Garden of Love,
That so many sweet flowers bore."

1. Name the poem from which these lines have been taken. (2 Marks)
2. Name the poet. (2 Marks)
3. What did he read on the door? (2 Marks)
4. What does "Thou shall not" mean? (2 Marks)
5. Are there any literary devices in this extract? If yes, Name one of it. (2 Marks)

- b). All the world's a stage,
"And all the men and women merely players,
They have their exits and entrances,
And one man in this time plays many parts,
His acts being seven ages."

1. What is the poem from which these lines have been taken? (2 Marks)
2. Who is the poet? (2 Marks)
3. Write a metaphor used in this poem. (2 Marks)
4. What does the poet mean by "Their exits and the entrances" (2 Marks)
5. How many roles does one man play during his life time? (2 Marks)

c). When death rattled
 "The gate at five
 One Sunday morning
 Took the old man away,
 Others trumpeted their ,
 Grief in loud sobs,
 And lachrymose blubber"

1. From which poem have these lines been taken? (2 Marks)
2. Name the poet. (2 Marks)
3. What does "Took the old man away" mean? (2 Marks)
4. What does the poet mean by "others" in the poem? (2 Marks)
5. How did they respond when the old man died? (2 Marks)

d). "A violet by a mossy stone
 Half hidden from the eye
 Fair as a star, when only one
 Shining in the sky"

1. Mention the poem which these lines have been taken? (2 Marks)
2. Name the poet. (2 Marks)
3. What poetic devices does the poet use in this poem? (2 Marks)
4. Name the person who is described in this poem? (2 Marks)
5. Describe the person mentioned in these lines in your own words. (2 Marks)

e). "Flash'd all the sabres bare,
 Flashed as they turned in air
 Sabring the gunners there,
 Charging an army, while,
 All the world wondered"

1. Name the poem from which these lines have been taken? (2 Marks)
2. Name the poet. (2 Marks)
3. What is a sabre? (2 Marks)
4. Why were "their sabres bare"? (2 Marks)
5. Explain. "while all the world wondered." (2 Marks)

SECTION B

Answer the questions in either a) or b)

- a) Read the following extract and answer the questions.

Jim was never late. Della doubled the fob chain in her hand and sat on the table near the door that he always entered . Then she heard his steps on the stairway down the first flight, and she turned white for just a moment. She had a habbit of saying a little silent prayer about the simplest everyday things , and now she whispered : Please god, make him think I am still pretty.”

1. What is the name of this story and its author? (2 Marks)
2. What is the fob chain mentioned in this story? (2 Marks)
3. What happened to her when she heard Jim’s steps on the stairs? (2 Marks)
4. What was the habit she had about everyday things? (2 Marks)
5. What was her prayer to god on this occasion? (2 Marks)

- b) His manners were perfect. He would never grab his food and start guzzling as the other monkeys did, without first giving you a greeting and thanking you with a series of his most expressive “hoo, hoos” Then he would eat delicately and slowly, pushing those pieces he did not want to the side of his plate. His only breach of table manners came to the end of a meal, for then he would seize his empty mug and plate and hurl them as far as possible.

1. From where has this extract been taken from and who is the author? (2 Marks)
2. What does the writer say about his manners? (2 Marks)
3. How do other monkeys eat according to the writer? (2 Marks)
4. Describe how the monkey mentioned in this extract eats. (2 Marks)
5. What does he do after finishing his meal? (2 Marks)

Part 11

POETRY

Answer one question only.

- 1) When you read “Mid term break” by Seamus Heany, one feels sad and hungry. How do you feel when you read it? Discuss. (15 marks)
- 2) Bertolt Brecht in his poem “A worker reads History” criticizes the historians? Do you agree with him? (15 marks)
- 3) What is your favourite poem in the collection of the poems of Diploma In English Course? Say why you like it? (15 marks)

PROSE

Answer one question only.

- 4) How did Della and Jim find money to buy their Christmas gifts? Should they have consulted each other before searching for presents. Discuss. (15 marks)
- 5) What do you think of the responsibility of the zoo keepers at the London zoo towards the death of Cholden? (15 marks)

NOVEL

Answer one question only.

- 6) Explain how Upali and his friend find freedom by moving to the island. Use examples from the novel "Madol Duwa" (25 marks)
- 7) How does Charles Dickens use the character of Oliver Twist to criticize the treatment of the poor in London? (25 marks)